Healthy Meal Planning at Home (with Weekly Chart)

With a weekly chart and shopping list — simple home food — Free preview

Meal planning does not mean strict rules — it means thinking a little at the start of the week about what to cook and what to buy. Then you do not have to wonder every day what to cook, and you are less likely to buy things you do not need at the market.

The biggest advantage of home food is that you know what goes into it. The amount of oil, salt and sugar is in your own hands, and fresh vegetables, lentils, fish and eggs can make a filling meal quite simply.

What is it?

This guide is built on the balanced-plate idea: about half the plate vegetables and fruit, about a quarter whole grains (such as brown rice, whole-wheat flour or oats), and about a quarter protein (such as fish, lentils, eggs or chicken). Water is the usual drink, and sugary drinks are best kept occasional.

The weekly chart is a sample — change it to fit your family's tastes, your budget and the vegetables in season. Try it for one week, notice which meals were easy and which ones everyone liked, and then plan the next week from what you learned.

How to start — a glimpse

1. At the start of the week, write down seven days of dinners in a notebook or on your phone — and note breakfast and lunch beside them too.
2. Keep the balanced-plate idea in mind for each main meal: half vegetables and fruit, a quarter whole grains, a quarter protein.

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